Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam-

First Semester MGU-UGP – BSW (Honours) Regular Examination November 2025

Multi-Disciplinary Courses - MG1MDCSWK101 - Pro- Social Behaviour And Active Citizenship**-**

QP Code: **25900958**

Part A Short Answer Questions- Answer any five questions / each question carries 3 marks

1	Explain the term fostering a culture of caring and its role in society. **Fostering a culture of caring** means creating an environment where people show empathy, respect, and support for one another, promoting well-being and positive relationships. a. **Promotes empathy and mutual support** c . **Strengthens social cohesion** b. **Improves collective well-being**	[U] / [CO1] 1 mark 2 marks
2	Give an example of pro-social behavior explained by Social Learning Theory (e.g., modeling). a. **Learning through observation**–Children watching parents donate to charity learn that helping is valued. b. **Imitation of rewarded behavior** – If a student sees a classmate praised for helping an elderly person, they imitate it. c. **Internalization of norms** – Repeated exposure to positive models forms lasting pro-social habits.	[A] / [CO2, CO3, CO4] 3 marks
3	Justify whether Goonj or The Hunger Project offers a more sustainable model for community development. a. **Goonj (India)** focuses on *waste-to-resource*, community-led solutions, and dignity-based development — creating local capacity and long-term sustainability. b. **The Hunger Project** empowers communities through women's leadership and long-term mobilization but often relies on external facilitation. c. **More sustainable:** *Goonj*—because its model uses local materials, builds community ownership, and reduces dependency.	[E] / [CO2, CO5] 3 marks
4	Explain Social Marketing as a strategy. How does Public Interest Litigation (PIL) function? **Social Marketing** a. **Uses marketing principles for social good** (e.g., health, environment, equality). b. **Behavior-change focus**—targets attitudes, norms, and practices. c. **Audience-centered strategies**—uses segmentation, messaging, and incentives to encourage positive actions. **Public Interest Litigation (PIL)** a. **Legal action for public wrongs**—filed to protect rights of disadvantaged groups. b. **Locus standi expanded**—any concerned citizen/organization can approach court. c. **Ensures accountability**—courts intervene when state agencies fail to uphold public interest	[U] / [CO2, CO4, CO5] 1.5 marks 1.5 marks
5	Judge whether self-efficacy or optimism is a more critical trait for the initial decision to act pro-socially. a. **Self-efficacy is more critical initially** because people act only if they believe *they can* make a meaningful difference. b. Optimism helps maintain effort long-term but does not necessarily trigger action. c. High self-efficacy directly predicts helping behavior in emergencies, volunteering, and cooperation.	[E] / [CO1, CO3] 3 marks
6	Describe the role of social equality in achieving positive social exchange outcomes. a. **Ensures fairness**—equal status increases trust and willingness to reciprocate. b. **Reduces power imbalance**—people feel safe to engage in mutual exchange. c. **Enhances cooperation**—equal opportunities lead to stable, long-term social relationships.	[U] / [CO4] 3 marks
7	How do socialization practices in childhood impact adult pro-sociality? a. **Modeling of empathy and sharing** in the family teaches children lifelong helping behaviors. b. **Discipline styles** - promote moral reasoning and cooperative attitudes. c. **Exposure to community values** - builds internal norms of responsibility and altruism.	[U] / [CO1, CO5 3 marks

Part B Essay Questions Answer any 2 Questions Each Question carries 10 marks

8	Critically examine the assertion that the single most effective strategy is the cultivation of individual traits like initiative and self-motivation a. **Empowers personal agency** – Initiative and self-motivation enable individuals to take ownership of actions without external prompting. b. **Drives sustained behavior** – Intrinsic motivation is more long-lasting than external rewards c. **Enhances adaptability** – Self-motivated individuals respond creatively to challenges and uncertainty. d. **Supports leadership and innovation** – Initiative encourages problem-solving and proactive contribution in community and workplace settings. e. **However, individual traits alone are insufficient** – Structural barriers (poverty, discrimination, lack of resources) limit the ability to act even for highly motivated individuals. f. **Social environment shapes motivation** – Family, culture, institutions, and role models influence the development of initiative. g. **Collective capacities matter** – Community networks, supportive policies, and enabling environments amplify individual traits. h. **Risk of victim-blaming** – Overemphasis on personal traits may ignore systemic injustices and shift responsibility onto individuals. i. **Balanced approach is needed** – Effective strategies combine individual empowerment with systemic support (education, opportunities, and social protection). j.	[E] / [CO2, CO3] 10 marks
9	Analyze the causes and consequences of the culture of silence and evaluate its impact as the most pervasive societal barrier a. **Fear of authority and repression** – People remain silent due to fear of punishment, stigma, or social backlash. b. **Lack of political empowerment** – Limited civic education and participation create passive citizenship. c. **Internalized oppression** – Marginalized groups begin to believe they have no right or ability to speak. d. **Social norms discouraging dissent** – Cultural expectations of obedience, hierarchy, and respect for elders/authority suppress voice. e. **Consequences: perpetuation of inequality** – Silence allows exploitation, corruption, and injustice to continue unchallenged. f. **Weak democratic participation** – Low levels of public discussion weaken policy accountability and governance. g. **Stagnation of social change** – Innovation and reform slow down when people do not question harmful traditions or systems. h. **Psychological impacts** – Learned helplessness, low self-confidence, and reduced agency become widespread. i. **Impact as a societal barrier** – Culture of silence becomes embedded across institutions, making collective problem-solving difficult. j. **Breaking silence is transformational** – Empowerment education, community mobilization, and participatory platforms can shift societies toward justice and awareness.	[E] / [CO2, CO4, CO5] 10 marks
10	Analyze the interplay between the values and the skills necessary for effective Active Citizenship. a. **Values provide motivation** – (justice, empathy, equality, responsibility) create the moral foundation for civic action. b. **Skills provide capacity** – Communication, negotiation, leadership, and problem-solving make civic participation effective. c. **Values shape ethical decision-making** – Without strong values, civic skills can be misused for personal or political gain. d. **Skills operationalize values** – Good intentions become meaningful action only when supported by practical abilities. e. **Mutual reinforcement** – Skills strengthen values by giving individuals confidence to act in alignment with their beliefs. f. **Democratic participation requires both** – Understanding rights (value) and knowing how to engage (skill) are equally essential. g. **Conflict resolution depends on both** – Respect (value) must pair with mediation or dialogue skills. h. **Community engagement thrives on synergy** – Collaborative values (trust, cooperation) combine with organizational skills to create impact. i. **Citizenship education must integrate both dimensions** – Training programs should build civic virtues along with competencies. j. **Effective Active Citizenship emerges when values and skills align** – Creating	[An] / [CO3, CO5] 10 marks

	informed, empowered, and responsible citizens.	
11	Analyze the Youth involvement during Kerala flood, 2018 through the lens of Social Learning Theory and Social Exchange Theory. **Social Learning Theory (SLT) perspective** 1. **Observation of role models** – Youth observed rescue teams, local leaders, and peers engaging in relief work, motivating imitation. 2. **Media and social media modeling** – Videos and stories of volunteers created powerful vicarious experiences. 3. **Reinforcement** – Positive feedback, appreciation from communities, and recognition by government encouraged sustained involvement. 4. **Collective identity formation** – Youth saw themselves as part of a helping community, reinforcing prosocial behavior. 5. **Internalization of norms** – Repeated exposure to altruistic acts internalized helping as a social norm. **Social Exchange Theory (SET) perspective** a. **Perceived benefits** – Youth gained social approval, sense of purpose, learning experiences, and psychological satisfaction. b. **Low perceived costs** –High solidarity & peer participation reduced fear & increased willingness to help. c. **Reciprocity expectation** – Helping others built a belief that society would support them in future crises. d. **Community support systems** – Organizations provided logistics, reducing personal burdens and increasing participation. e. **Outcome** – Cost–benefit balance, combined with strong social modeling, resulted in massive voluntary youth mobilization.	[An] / [CO2, CO4] 5 marks 5 marks